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New Crimes Calls for New Security Measures

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LOUISVILLE, Ky.—Today, horse jockey Flavien Prat was accused of two crimes at Churchill Downs while testing new thoroughbreds during off season preparation for the Kentucky Derby.

First, a thoroughbred mare, Lucky Spike, was found deceased in a pasture near her barn. Lucky Spike was to be Prat's horse for the Derby but was recently assigned to a different jockey. Veterinarians confirmed that she had been poisoned. Secondly, the tires of the US Thoroughbred Racing Association CEO Tom Rooney were slashed behind the parking lot at Churchill Downs.

"At this time security has not been able to identify who slashed the tires of Tom Rooney, but our team is working diligently to get to the bottom of it" said Churchill Downs President, Mike Anderson. "We were deeply hurt by the death of Lucky Spike and are doing everything in our power to be sure that these issues are taken care of."

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ABOUT: Churchill Downs Incorporated (CDI) is a premier racing, gaming, and entertainment company that owns and operates some of the most iconic venues in the United States. Founded in 1875, the company is best known for its flagship property, Churchill Downs Racetrack in Louisville, Kentucky, home of the world-famous Kentucky Derby. Over the years, CDI has grown and diversified its portfolio, which now includes a range of facilities offering thoroughbred racing, casinos, sports betting, and other entertainment options.